

PUQI ZHOU

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Seeking research internships: Spring / Summer 2027

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on **human-centered multi-robot systems**: I model **human attention and behavior**, and use these models to design **adaptive interfaces and shared autonomy** for real-world robot teams in high-stakes settings.

EDUCATION

Ph.D.	George Mason University (GMU), Fairfax, VA, USA Computer Science Advisor: David Porfirio	2021–present
B.Eng.	University College Dublin (UCD), Dublin, Ireland Beijing University of Technology (BJUT), Beijing, China Dual degree in Electronic and Information Engineering Merit Student (Top 5%); Outstanding Student Cadre (Top 5%)	2017–2021

RESEARCH POSITIONS

George Mason University

Ph.D. Student, Department of Computer Science 09/2025–present
Human-Centered Multi-Robot Systems
Advisor: Prof. David Porfirio

- Developed Attune, a self-annotation tool combining robot-camera video, eye tracking, and AI-assisted annotation to characterize operator attention profiles during multi-robot supervision (UIST 2026).
- Model how robot motion, visual information, and task context shape human attention over time.
- Design adaptive interfaces and shared autonomy that preserve operator control, including social behavior during robot teleoperation.

George Mason University

Ph.D. Student, Department of Computer Science 08/2023–present
Multi-Robot Video Sensemaking
Project advisors: Profs. Sungsoo (Ray) Hong, Chris Thomas, Xuesu Xiao, and Michael Hieb

- Designed and studied multi-robot ground video sensemaking with public-safety professionals, bringing together multiple video streams, event explanations, and event-review tools (CHI 2026).

University College Dublin

Research Assistant 09/2020–07/2021
Indoor Wireless Positioning
Advisor: Prof. Xingqi Zhang

CONFERENCE PAPERS

1. **Zhou, P.**, Hong, S. R., & Porfirio, D. (2026, November). Attune: A Self-Annotation Tool for Understanding Robot Operator Attention Profiles. In *Proceedings of the 39th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST)*. [\[Project\]](#) [\[Paper\]](#)
2. **Zhou, P.**, Asgarov, A., Hussain, A., Park, W., Paudyal, A., Shrestha, S., Tang, C.-W., Lighthiser, M. F., Hieb, M. R., Xiao, X., Thomas, C., & Hong, S. R. (2026, April). Designing Multi-Robot Ground Video Sensemaking with Public Safety Professionals. In *Proceedings of the ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. [\[Project\]](#) [\[Paper\]](#)

3. Liu, Y., **Zhou, P.**, Zhang, Z., Zhang, A., Han, B., Li, Z., & Qian, F. (2024, November). MuV2: Scaling up Multi-user Mobile Volumetric Video Streaming via Content Hybridization and Sharing. In *Proceedings of the 30th ACM Conference on Mobile Computing and Networking (MobiCom)*. [\[Paper\]](#)
4. Wu, N., Liu, K., Cheng, R., Han, B., & **Zhou, P.** (2024, June). Theia: Gaze-driven and Perception-aware Volumetric Content Delivery for Mixed Reality Headsets. In *Proceedings of the 22nd ACM Conference on Mobile Systems, Applications and Services (MobiSys)*. [\[Paper\]](#)
5. Jin, Q., Liu, Y., Sun, R., Chen, C., **Zhou, P.**, Han, B., Qian, F., & Yarosh, S. (2023, April). Collaborative Online Learning with VR Video: Roles of Collaborative Tools and Shared Video Control. In *Proceedings of the ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. [\[Paper\]](#)
6. Zhang, D., **Zhou, P.**, Han, B., & Pathak, P. H. (2022, November). M5: Facilitating Multi-user Volumetric Content Delivery with Multi-lobe Multicast over mmWave. In *Proceedings of the 20th ACM Conference on Embedded Networked Sensor Systems (SenSys)*. [\[Paper\]](#)

WORKSHOP PAPERS AND COMPANION PROCEEDINGS

1. Jin, Q., Liu, Y., **Zhou, P.**, Han, B., Yarosh, S., & Qian, F. (2023, March). Volumivive: An Authoring System for Adding Interactivity to Volumetric Video. In *IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces Abstracts and Workshops (VRW)*. [\[Paper\]](#)

HONORS AND AWARDS

Doctoral Research Scholarship, George Mason University Tier 1	2026–2027
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

George Mason University	<i>Teaching Assistant</i>
CS 600, Theory of Computation	Spring 2026
CS 551, Computer Graphics	Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2025
CS 695, Immersive Computing	Spring 2023

ADVISING AND MENTORSHIP

Darsh Shetty — Academy of Engineering and Technology	2025
Wonjoon Park — UMD	2024–present
Karthik Nutulapati — GMU	2024–2025

EXTERNAL SERVICE

Event Organization	
ACM SenSys N2Women (Networking Women)	2022
Referee Service	
CHI — ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems	2023, 2025, 2026
IUI — ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces	2026
CSCW — ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work & Social Computing	2025

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, Java, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, C#, C, PDDL
Robotics and interactive systems: ROS 2, MuJoCo, OpenCV, Unity
Robot platforms: Hello Robot Stretch 3, Frodo Robot
Research methods: Eye tracking, video annotation, user studies, interaction prototyping
Design: Figma, Affinity